# *46 Stories in Classical Greek*

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More Attic Greek readings, from the supplementary text to Anne H. Groton's *From Alpha to Omega*. Translated as part of homework for GREEK 101 with Prof. Olga Levaniouk at the University of Washington.

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## Chapter 5: An Unproductive Business Plan

### Adapted from Aesop's Fable 58

Δέσποινα ὄρνῖν ἔχει. ἡ ὄρνῖς ἅπαξ τῆς ἡμέρᾱς ᾠὸν τίκτει. ἐπειδὴ ἡ δέσποινα σπεύδει πλείονα ᾠὰ ἔχειν, κελεύει τὰς θεραπαίνᾱς τῇ ὄρνῑθι πλείονα τροφὴν βάλλειν. καὶ τῇ ὄρνῑθι κελεύει, "Ορᾱ πλείονα ᾠὰ τίκτειν. δὶς τῆς ἡμέρᾱς, ὦ ὄρνῑ, τίκτε ᾠόν.

ἐπεὶ αἱ θεράπαιναι τῆς δεσποίνης ἀκούουσιν, ἐκ τῶν κλῑνῶν σπεύδουσι καὶ τῇ ὄρνῑθι πλείονα τροφὴν βάλλουσιν. τὴν ὄρνῑν ἡ τροφὴ βλάπτει· οὐδ΄ ἅπαξ τῆς ἡμέρᾱς ᾠὰ τίκτει.

ἐπεὶ σπεύδεις, ὦ δέσποινα, ᾠὰ ἔχειν, τὴν ὄρνῑν μὴ βλάπτε.

The mistress possesses a hen. During the day, the hen lays an egg. Since the mistress hastens to possess more eggs, she orders the servants to throw more chicken feed to the hen. And she orders the hen, "It is time to lay more eggs. Lay eggs twice during the day, hen."

When the servants hear the mistress, they hasten out of their beds and throw more chicken feed to the hen. The chicken feed harms the hen; not even once does it lay eggs during the day.

When you are eager, mistress, to possess eggs, do not harm the hen.